Asset Tracker

Setting Up Online Sync

A step-by-step guide to keeping a safe online copy of your inventory

Version	2026.001
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Time needed	About 45 minutes

Before you start

Asset Tracker keeps your list of belongings, photos and receipts on your computer. Online sync also keeps a copy on the internet, using a free Google service called **Firebase**. If your computer is ever lost, stolen or damaged, you can bring everything back on a new one.

Before anything leaves your computer, Asset Tracker locks it with a password that only you know, called your **sync password**. Google stores the locked copy but cannot open it.

What you need

1. A computer with Asset Tracker installed.
2. A Google account, such as a Gmail address. If you don't have one, create one first at **accounts.google.com**.
3. A credit or debit card. Google asks for one to turn on file storage. For a home inventory the cost is normally **nothing**. See Part 2.
4. A pen, and the record sheet on the next page.

How to follow this guide

Words in **bold** are the names of buttons, menus and boxes exactly as they appear on screen. An arrow means "then click": **Project settings** → **General** means click Project settings, then click General.

> **Good to know**
>
> Google changes the look of its screens from time to time. If a button has a slightly different name than in this guide, click the closest match.

Your record sheet

Fill this in as you go. You will need these details again if you set up a new computer. Keep the sheet somewhere safe, such as with your insurance papers.

Item	Where it comes from	Write it here
Google account email	The Gmail address you use for Firebase	
Project ID	Part 1, step 4	
App login email	Part 3, step 7	
App login password	Part 3, step 7	
API key	Part 6, step 7	
Storage bucket	Part 6, step 7	
Sync password	Part 7, step 6	

Important

Never lose your sync password. It cannot be reset or recovered, by you, by Uhlix or by Google. Without it, your online copy can never be opened again.

Write it on this sheet, or keep it in a password manager.

Part 1

Create your Firebase project

A "project" is your own private space in Firebase. Asset Tracker will store your online copy there.

1. Open your web browser and go to **console.firebase.google.com**. Sign in with your Google account if asked.
2. Click the button to create a new project. It may say **Create a project**, **Get started by setting up a Firebase project** or **Add project**.
3. Type a name for your project, for example **My Asset Tracker**.
4. Under the name, Firebase shows a **Project ID**, such as my-asset-tracker-1a2b3. Write it on your record sheet.
5. If asked, tick the box to accept the Firebase terms, then click **Continue**.
6. If asked about **AI assistance** (Gemini), you can turn it off. Asset Tracker doesn't need it. Click **Continue**.
7. If asked about **Google Analytics**, turn it off. Asset Tracker doesn't need it.
8. Click **Create project**. Wait a minute while Firebase gets it ready, then click **Continue**.

You are now looking at your project's main page. The menu down the left-hand side is used for the rest of this guide.

Part 2

Turn on file storage billing

Google requires a payment card on your project before it will store files such as photos. This is called the **Blaze** plan, which means "pay only for what you use".

> **Good to know**
>
> Google gives every project a free allowance each month. A home inventory with photos and receipts normally stays well inside it, so you should not be charged.
>
> Charges only start if you use far more storage than a typical home inventory needs.

1. In the menu on the left, near the bottom, click **Upgrade**. You may also see it later when you set up storage in Part 5. Either place is fine.
2. Choose the **Blaze** plan.
3. Follow the screens to add your card details. Google calls this a **Cloud Billing account**.
4. If Google offers to set a **budget**, type a small amount such as **1** (one dollar), so that Google emails you if anything is ever charged.
5. Finish the screens until you return to your project.

> **Important**
>
> A budget only **warns** you by email. It does not stop charges. If you ever get a budget email, contact whoever supports your Asset Tracker.

Part 3

Create your login for Asset Tracker

Asset Tracker signs in to your project with its own email and password. You create that login here. It can be the same email as your Google account, but use a different password.

1. In the menu on the left, click **Security** → **Authentication**. In some versions it is under **Build** instead of **Security**.
2. Click **Get started**.
3. Click the **Sign-in method** tab.
4. Click **Email/Password**.
5. Turn on the first switch, the one labelled **Email/Password**. Leave the second one (**Email link**) off.
6. Click **Save**.
7. Click the **Users** tab, then **Add user**. Type an email address and a password, then click **Add user**. Write both on your record sheet as the **app login**.

Part 4

Create the database

The database holds the details of each item: names, values, dates and notes.

1. In the menu on the left, click **Databases & Storage** → **Firestore**. In some versions it is under **Build** and called **Firestore Database**.
2. Click **Create database**.
3. If asked to choose an edition, choose **Standard**.
4. Choose a **location**. Pick one in or near your country. If you're in the United States, choose **us-central1**. Click **Next**. The location can't be changed later.
5. Choose **Start in production mode**, then click **Create**.
6. When the database is ready, click the **Rules** tab at the top.
7. Select all the text in the large box and delete it. Then type in exactly the text below, or copy it from this PDF and paste it in:

```
rules_version = '2';
service cloud.firestore {
  match /databases/{database}/documents {
    match /users/{userId}/{document=**} {
      allow read, write: if request.auth != null
                         && request.auth.uid == userId;
    }
  }
}
```

8. Click **Publish**.

> **Good to know**
>
> These rules mean that only you, when signed in, can read or change your data. Nobody else can see it, even if they know your Project ID.

Part 5

Create file storage

File storage holds your photos and receipts.

1. In the menu on the left, click **Databases & Storage** → **Storage**. In some versions it is under **Build**.
2. If Firebase asks you to upgrade, follow Part 2 first, then come back here.
3. Click **Get started**.
4. Choose a **location**. Choose **US-CENTRAL1**, **US-EAST1** or **US-WEST1**. These three include Google's free storage allowance. Other locations are charged from the first file.
5. If asked about security rules, choose **Start in production mode**.
6. Click **Done** or **Create**.
7. Click the **Rules** tab at the top.
8. Select all the text in the large box and delete it. Then type in exactly the text below, or copy it from this PDF and paste it in:

```
rules_version = '2';
service firebase.storage {
  match /b/{bucket}/o {
    match /users/{userId}/{allPaths=**} {
      allow read, write: if request.auth != null
                         && request.auth.uid == userId;
    }
  }
}
```

9. Click **Publish**.

Part 6

Find your project details

Asset Tracker needs three details to find your project. To get them, you register Asset Tracker with your project.

1. Click the **gear icon** next to **Project Overview** at the top left, then **Project settings**.
2. On the **General** tab, scroll down to **Your apps**.
3. Click the **Web** icon. It looks like this: **</>**
4. Type a nickname, such as **Asset Tracker**. Leave the Firebase Hosting box unticked. Click **Register app**.
5. Firebase shows some code. You don't need to do anything with it. Click **Continue to console**.
6. Back on **Project settings**, scroll down to **Your apps** again. Under **SDK setup and configuration**, choose **Config**.
7. Find these two lines and write the text between the quote marks on your record sheet:

```
apiKey: "AIzaSy...this long code is your API key..."
storageBucket: "my-asset-tracker-1a2b3.firebasestorage.app"
```

Write this down

The **API key** is a long code starting with **AIza**. Copy it exactly: capital and small letters matter.

The **Storage bucket** normally ends in **.firebasestorage.app**.

Part 7

Connect Asset Tracker

Now you tell Asset Tracker how to reach your project, and choose your sync password.

1. Open Asset Tracker. Click **File → Sync to Cloud (Firebase)...**
2. On the **Firebase** tab, fill in **API key**, **Project ID** and **Storage bucket** from your record sheet. The storage bucket box shows an example in grey; type over it.
3. In **Email** and **Password**, type your **app login** from Part 3. This is not your Google password.
4. Click the **Encryption** tab.
5. Choose a **sync password**. Make it long and memorable, such as four unrelated words.
6. Type it into **Sync password**, and write it on your record sheet **now**.
7. If this is your own computer, tick **Remember on this PC** so you don't have to type it every time. It is stored locked to your Windows account.
8. Click **Save Settings**, then **Sync Now**.

The first sync can take a few minutes if you have many photos. When it finishes, the window says **Sync complete**, with the number of items and files sent.

> **Good to know**
>
> Run **Sync Now** again whenever you add or change items. Asset Tracker does not sync on its own.

Part 8

The Android app

The current Asset Tracker Android app connects only to the Uhlix Firebase project. It cannot yet open a project you have set up yourself with this guide.

Your online copy is still fully useful without it: it protects your inventory, and Part 9 explains how to bring it back on a new computer.

> **Good to know**
> This guide will be updated with Android steps when a version of the app that supports your own project is available. Check the version number on the cover to see whether you have the latest guide.

Part 9

Everyday use and problems

Bringing everything back on a new computer

1. Install Asset Tracker on the new computer.
2. Click **File → Sync to Cloud (Firebase)...** and fill in every box from your record sheet, including the sync password.
3. Click **Restore from Cloud...** and answer **Yes**.
4. Wait while your items, photos and receipts are downloaded. Anything already on that computer is kept in a separate folder, not deleted.

If something goes wrong

The message says	What to do
Authentication failed	The email or password on the Firebase tab is wrong. Use the **app login** from Part 3, not your Google password. To set a new one, go to **Authentication → Users** in Firebase, click the three dots next to the user, then **Reset password**.
API key not valid	The API key was copied wrongly. Copy it again from Part 6, step 7.
Different Sync Password	The sync password doesn't match your online copy. If you mistyped it, choose **No** and type it again. Choose **Yes** only if you have truly lost it: your computer's copy will be sent again under the new password.
Storage upload failed	File storage isn't ready. Check that Part 2 (billing) and Part 5 (storage, including the rules) are done.
Firestore write failed	The database rules weren't published. Repeat Part 4, steps 6 to 8.
Assets Only in the Cloud	Your online copy has items that are no longer on this computer. Choose **Yes** only if you deleted them on purpose. If you're unsure, choose **No**: nothing is lost.